

MX Linux vs Linux Mint: which one should you really choose in 2026?

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If you are choosing a distro “to use every day”, it is very likely that you ended up here with a simple question:

is MX Linux better or Linux Mint?

The short answer is this:

- **Linux Mint** is the most “plug & play” choice for people coming from Windows who want zero hassle.
- **MX Linux** is the most “stable and controllable” choice if you want a solid, lightweight system that is easy to manage (especially thanks to MX Tools).

But to choose correctly (and not change distro after two weeks) you need to understand **what really changes** between the two.

What they have in common: why both are smart choices

Before talking about differences, let’s make one thing clear: **both work very well.**

- they are beginner-friendly distros
- they have huge communities
- they are stable (not aggressive rolling releases)
- they work well on both old PCs and modern hardware

So you are not choosing between “good or bad”. You are choosing **the type of experience**.

1) Performance: which one is faster?

In general:

- **MX Linux Xfce** tends to be lighter and more responsive on weaker hardware (limited RAM, low power CPU, slower SSD).
- **Linux Mint (Cinnamon)** is heavier but also more modern in appearance, and works perfectly on mid-range or modern PCs.

Simple rule:

- Old PC / mini PC / 8 GB RAM → MX Linux often feels more responsive
- Modern PC / 16 GB+ RAM → Mint runs smoothly and gives a more “Windows-like” experience

If you want to squeeze the best performance out of MX Linux, here is a guide that really makes a difference:

👉 [Make MX Linux faster: 10 tweaks that change everything](#)

2) Ease of use for people coming from Windows

Here Mint clearly wins, especially with **Cinnamon**:

- very intuitive menus and settings
- an interface already similar to Windows
- fewer decisions to make right after installation

MX Linux is not difficult at all: it’s simply more “practical” and less “polished”.

And if the interface is the issue, there is something many people don’t know:

you can make MX Linux look almost identical to Windows 10/11 in just a few steps.

👉 [How to make MX Linux look like Windows 10 or Windows 11 \(complete guide\)](#)

3) Stability and updates: which one gives you more peace of mind?

This is interesting, because both focus on stability but in slightly different ways:

- **Linux Mint** is very balanced: stable, with well-managed updates and a very comfortable base.
- **MX Linux** is often perceived as even more “problem-free”: fewer surprises and a very practical approach.

If you want a PC that **always works** and you don’t care about chasing the latest update every week, MX is a very strong choice.

If you want a distro that is extremely user-friendly and polished, Mint is perfect.

In the blog you can also read an article about Mint’s development strategy:

👉 [Linux Mint changes strategy: fewer unnecessary updates, more real stability](#)

4) MX Tools: the difference that (almost) nobody considers

This is where MX Linux plays its strongest card.

MX Tools is a graphical suite that allows you to do in just a couple of clicks things that on other distros require the terminal, tutorials, or several different tools.

- system snapshots and backups
- boot repair
- repository and package management
- drivers, codecs and tweaks
- practical time-saving utilities

If you want to understand why MX Linux is so appreciated (not only on mini PCs but also on modern laptops and workstations), here is the full guide:

👉 [MX Tools: the ultimate guide \(2026\)](#)

5) Software and app installation: which one is easier?

In practice, both allow you to do everything: browsing, office work, multimedia, and professional tools.

Mint is more straightforward for people coming from Windows: you often find everything ready to use.

MX Linux is cleaner and gives you more control, especially thanks to its built-in tools.

A simple but powerful tip for both: use Flatpak for modern and frequently updated apps.

6) Which one to choose for Mini PCs (N100/N150, Ryzen low power, etc.)

If your priority is low power consumption, silence, real speed and fewer problems...

- **MX Linux Xfce** is often the best choice: lightweight and responsive.
- **Linux Mint Cinnamon** works well, but if you notice small slowdowns, Mint Xfce or MX may be better.

If you want a practical guide to installing MX Linux, here it is:

👉 [MX Linux: complete guide \(installation + first steps\)](#)

7) Which one to choose for modern PCs and recent laptops

Here the choice becomes more personal:

- if you want a modern look and immediate ease of use → **Linux Mint**
- if you want stability, lightness, integrated tools and control → **MX Linux**

Important: MX Linux is not just for “old computers”. On modern hardware it has a huge advantage: fewer unnecessary background processes, more stability, and a set of tools that saves you time.

MX Linux vs Linux Mint (in 10 seconds)

- **Choose Linux Mint** if you want an extremely easy, modern experience similar to Windows.
- **Choose MX Linux** if you want a stable, lightweight system with practical integrated tools.

If you want, tell me in the comments:

- what PC you have (CPU + RAM)
- if you are coming from Windows 10/11
- what you mainly use your computer for (web, work, gaming, study)

And I'll tell you which one is really the best choice for you.